

Apple iPhone 4S

The launch of the iPhone 4S saw sales of over four million devices over a period of two days

**Aakash in the US**

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A war in your pocket

A round-up of the current mobile platforms vying for your attention

Symbian OS

Symbian and Nokia have shared a very long and rich heritage in India, with the Nokia Symbian 60 devices being literally synonymous with smartphones. Nokia later bought Symbian OS in 2008 and started developing S60v5 as Symbian ^1 through to the current Belle. A variant of the S60v5, the primary upgrade to the OS was the integration of the UI into the OS itself, which resulted in an increase in performance. By this time of course, the iPhone and Android had launched and Symbian has desperately been trying to play catch-up ever since. The cur-



rent update, Belle, introduced re-sizeable, live, widgets and, notifications in the lock-screen, NFC and numerous UI tweaks. The interface is also quite zippy and the browser is one of the few mobile browsers that supports flash natively. The future of this OS is still dicey though, especially with its owner, Nokia, planning a switch to the Windows Phone 7.5 OS.

Apple iOS

The birth of the iOS, formerly iPhone OS, dates back to 2007. At the time it was launched, Nokia with its Symbian OS and BlackBerry OS were the reigning kings of the smartphone market. The initial version of the OS was quite simplistic, lacking even copy-paste functionality. The OS was originally developed for the iPhone, but later on further developed as a platform for all apple devices except the iMac. The OS started picking up speed at an exponential rate and almost single-handedly ousted Nokia

from its top spot in the smartphone market by the time iOS 4 was out. The features it introduced were quite revolutionary at the time, but with the advent of the open-source Android OS and the growing threat from Microsoft with its upcoming "Mango" update, iOS 4 started to look old very fast. Finally, apple announced its iOS 5 upgrade for iPhone, iPod touch and iPad. The upgrade, while absolutely huge in terms of features was, again, mostly essential updates and just enough to keep the OS at the same level as its competition. iOS 5 did

bring along some very interesting features such as air-play mirroring, an improved browser, support for cloud services, PC-less operation and many more. Apple iOS used to set the standard for OSes in its heyday, but at the rate at which OSes are evolving, the iOS is now struggling to keep up. The OS is still as popular as



ever though, and as long as Apple keeps updating their software, it is very unlikely that iOS will fall from favour any time soon.

Windows Phone

Microsoft has been making mobile operating systems for almost 10 years now. The interface then looked more like a simplified version of Windows Desktop OS. Windows Mobile underwent a slow evolution, but it wasn't till WM6 and further updates that the OS actually acknowledged the fact that a touchscreen needed something more than a stylus. The interface underwent a serious overhaul, and started incorporating a text based UI. Finally, in 2010, Microsoft launched the completely revamped Windows Mobile OS as Windows Phone 7. The interface was a very unique, list-based Metro "design language". That and the introduction of "live" tiles set the OS apart from its brethren. The initial WP7 OS was an aesthetically pleasing, but essentially crippled OS, not even having the ability to set custom ring tones. It took 2 major upgrades, NODO and Mango, to bring the OS up to speed with the current generation platforms. At its current state, WP7.5, the OS is packed to the gills with features and can give any current mobile OS a run for its money. It does, however, suffer from a severe lack of apps. A complete list of features can be found at <http://bit.ly/WPmAnGo>.

